PicoTerm Quick Reference

Oct 26, 2026 · @Gene

PicoTerm 0.1 is a CoCo 3 terminal for the Pocket Pico: 1200 baud, 8 data bits, no parity, 1 stop bit, 80 columns. Nothing to set up.

Starting PicoTerm

The SD card in the CoCo SDC holds `PICOTERM.DSK`. Plug the cable into the Pico and power it up, then type these two lines on the CoCo, pressing ENTER after each:

```
DRIVE 0,"PICOTERM.DSK"
RUN"PICOTERM"
```

PicoTerm wakes up the Pico by itself. Look for "The Pocket Pico is answering. Ready." and then the Pico's `cmd:` prompt. PicoTerm's own messages show in yellow; text from the Pico shows in white.

Keys

The CoCo keyboard has no Ctrl-C key, no backspace and no `|` or `~`, so PicoTerm maps them to these keys. Press **F1** any time to see a short version on screen.

CoCo key	What it does
BREAK	Ctrl-C (back to the `cmd:` prompt)
CLEAR	Clear the screen
CTRL + letter	Control key (CTRL+Z = Ctrl-Z)
LEFT arrow	Backspace
SHIFT+0	Caps lock on/off (starts on)
F1	Help on screen
SHIFT+F1	Wake up the Pocket Pico again
F2	Quit to BASIC (press Y to confirm, any other key to stay)

Special characters, typed with CTRL plus a key:

CTRL +	1	3	7	8	9	,	-	.	/
Types	|	~	^	[	]	{	_	}	\ (backslash)

The CoCo's font shows `^` as an up arrow and `_` as a left arrow on screen. The Pico still gets the right characters.

If the Pico doesn't answer

PicoTerm says "No answer from the Pocket Pico" after about 9 seconds. Check these in order, then press **SHIFT+F1** to try again:

1. The Pico is powered on and the 3.5 mm plug is all the way in.
2. The cable's power is on (the test cable needs its 12 V supply).
3. The Pico's jack speed is 1200. Connect the Pico to the PC by USB, open PuTTY, type `ABAUD` at `cmd:`. If it doesn't say 1200, see below.

Setting the jack speed back to 1200 (in PuTTY over USB, at `cmd:`):

1. `TXDELAY` and note the number it shows (call it n).
2. `ABAUD 1200`

3. `TXDELAY` n+1, then `TXDELAY` n. Each one saves the settings to flash ("Saving Ram Data to Flash").
4. `RESTART`. It should show `TTL Serial= 1200, 8, 1, None`.

The TXDELAY change matters: ABAUD by itself is not saved and goes back to 115200 at the next power-up. Never use `RESET`; it erases all the Pico's settings.